

Invitation to the 2nd Belgian – Dutch Scabies Research symposium

Organized by the Belgium Dutch scabies network and the Dutch Consortium for Scabies Control



Date: October 14th 2026

Time: 11:00 – 18:00

Location: Timmerhuis, Halvemaanpassage 1, Rotterdam, the Netherlands

For whom: Researchers and professionals with an interest in scabies research and its application to public health practice, clinical care, prevention, and control in Belgium and the Netherlands.

Program: See full program below.

Lunch and drinks will be provided.

Registration: Please register via the following link:

<https://forms.cloud.microsoft/e/uQaKp4mxSn>

As the number of places is limited, we encourage you to register as soon as possible.

We look forward to welcoming you in Rotterdam for a day of scientific exchange, collaboration, and discussion on scabies research and control.

Fraukje Mevissen, Ewout Fanoy, Soledad Colombe, Wilma Stolk



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2nd Belgian – Dutch Scabies Research Symposium

October 14th 2026 – Timmerhuis, Halvemaanpassage 1, Rotterdam, the Netherlands

Programme outline



- 11:00 – 11:15** Opening by Dr. Yvonne van Duijnhoven, DPH, GGD Rotterdam Rijnmond
- 11:15 – 11:35** Scratching Beneath the Surface: Updates from the Dutch Consortium for Scabies Control (*Wilma Stolk, Erasmus MC*)
- 11:35 – 11:55** Update on the epidemiological situation and surveillance in Belgium in 2026 (*Valeska Laisnez, Sciensano*)
- 11:55 – 12:15** The Strategy for Addressing Future Scabies Epidemics in Nursing Homes (SAFE-NH) Study (*Eveline Coemans, University Hasselt*)
- 12:15 – 12:30** Discussion
- 12:30 – 13:30** Lunch
- 13:30 – 13:50** Development of a Scabies App to support students in implementing treatment and prevention measures (*Sunia Somra, GGD Rotterdam – Rijnmond*)
- 13:50 – 14:10** The hidden passenger: detecting scabies in laundry water (*Marlous Prins, Erasmus MC*)
- 14:10 – 14:30** – Comparison of scabies guidelines on environmental and hygiene measures in Europe (*Soledad Colombe, Institute of Tropical Medicine*)
- 14:30 - 15:00** – Coffee & tea break
- 15:00–16:30** – Interactive workshops

Workshop 1 - Scabies Diagnosis in Focus: From Photo-Based Training to AI

Jozefien Groenendijk & Ewout Fanoy, GGD regio Utrecht)

How can healthcare professionals improve the recognition of scabies, and what role might AI play in the future of diagnosis? In this interactive workshop, participants will be introduced to a new scabies photo library, recent research on AI-supported image analysis, and a pilot training module designed to enhance diagnostic skills. You will work hands-on with a selection of clinical images and practice identifying signs of scabies using a structured approach. The workshop concludes with a thought-provoking discussion on the opportunities and ethical challenges of AI and teledermatology in scabies care.

Workshop 2 - From Innovation to Implementation: Prioritising Research Questions for Scabies Control

Soledad Colombe, ITG & Wilma Stolk, Erasmus MC

Novel diagnostic tools, digital treatment support, alternative treatment strategies, and even targeted mass drug administration are among the innovations currently being developed to improve scabies control. But which questions still need to be answered before these innovations can be implemented in practice? In this workshop, policymakers, healthcare professionals, and researchers will work together to identify and prioritise the most important research questions. By contributing your expertise, you will help shape a shared Dutch-Belgian research agenda that can support the future implementation of innovative approaches to scabies control.

Workshop 3 - Building a Scabies Transmission Model Through Co-Creation

Marlous Prins & Sake de Vlas, Erasmus MC

How does scabies spread, and which interventions are likely to have the greatest impact? In this interactive workshop, participants will explore how mathematical models can support better decision-making for scabies control and policy development. Working together with fellow participants, you will contribute to the development of a transmission model tailored to the Belgian and Dutch context. Discussions will focus on transmission pathways, high-risk groups, diagnostic delays, and other key factors that influence the spread and control of scabies. This workshop offers a unique opportunity to translate your professional expertise into a tool that can help inform future policy and practice.

16:30 – 17:00 Plenary feedback per workshop-group and closing

17:00 – 18:00 Networking drinks (formal end 18:00)

18:00 – 20:00 Dinner (optional, at own expense; venue to be confirmed).



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